

1 • THE SESSION

AT A GLANCE

STEVE CUMMINS Principal / Chief Marketer, Solent Strategies	DATE SESSION 7 FRI SEPT 25 • 12:30 PM ET 30 minutes • virtual	FORMAT PRESENTATION, THEN Q&A Aimed at: Pre-revenue and testing the market • generating revenue • raising
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SESSION TITLE, AS THEY SUBMITTED IT

Marketing that Maps the Customer Journey

OPEN TO OTHER DATES

Yes

OPEN TO A SERIES, UP TO THREE SESSIONS

Maybe, wants to discuss

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

A one-pager built for the session, plus an 8-page eBook, Building a Realistic Marketing Strategy. Both go in the cohort resource library under his name.

DECK

Deck exists, in Drive. Final version due 72 hours before.

2 • THE ASK

WHAT TO BUILD, AND BY WHEN

- **20 minutes of slides** walking the journey stage by stage, with the tactics that belong at each
- Close on **the one or two tactics this cohort should pick**, so the room leaves with a decision
- **10 minutes of questions** at the end

STEP 1 • IMMEDIATELY Calendar hold for this slot goes out as soon as the date is confirmed.	STEP 2 • WEEK PRIOR 15 minute sync call. Lock the title and intro, walk the shape of the 30 minutes, confirm recording and promotion, tech check.	STEP 3 • 72 HOURS OUT Deck due , if a deck is being used, so we can prep and promote.
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SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- Which one or two tactics we close on, so the room leaves with a decision
- Who moderates and how questions reach you, live in chat or read out
- Whether the one-pager and the eBook go into the cohort resource library under your name

3 • LUMA EVENT PAGE

DRAFT COPY, FOR YOUR APPROVAL

Marketing that Maps the Customer Journey

UPLIFT EXPERT SESSION • FRI SEPT 25 • 12:30 PM ET • VIRTUAL • 30 MINUTES

ABOUT THIS SESSION

Every founder is told to do marketing, and everyone they ask has a different opinion. Steve Cummins, a fractional CMO with more than 20 years in B2B marketing, walks the customer journey stage by stage and shows which tactics actually belong at each one. You will leave able to define the goal of your marketing, name what has to be in place before you spend anything, and pick the one or two things to do well instead of covering every base.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Define the goal of your marketing, then match tactics to each stage
- What has to be in place before you spend: a clear message, a defined reachable audience
- Do one or two things well rather than covering every base

ABOUT STEVE

Steve helps growing businesses punch above their weight, working with companies who are ready to take marketing seriously but are not ready for a full time CMO. That means developing the right message, reaching a broader audience, and executing a marketing plan tailored for their business. Steve has an engineering background and more than 20 years experience in global B2B marketing with name-brand companies and feisty start-ups. He also coaches and mentors marketers and teams of one.

1 • THE SESSION

AT A GLANCE

ERIC SCHMALZBAUER Former co-founder & CEO, Prospective	DATE SESSION 2 MON SEPT 14 • 12:30 PM ET 30 minutes • virtual	FORMAT FIRESIDE CHAT Aimed at: Any founder in the cohort
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SESSION TITLE, AS THEY SUBMITTED IT

B2B: from idea > funding > failure

OPEN TO OTHER DATES

Yes

OPEN TO A SERIES, UP TO THREE SESSIONS

Maybe, wants to discuss

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

Workbench Ventures GTM Weekly newsletter. Open to a series: GTM from scratch, and investor management.

DECK

None needed for a fireside.

2 • THE ASK

WHAT TO BUILD, AND BY WHEN

- **No deck required.** We interview him and founders ask questions
- Bring **three questions he wishes someone had asked** at the start, which become the run of show
- Agree **what he is comfortable naming out loud**: numbers, timelines, the decision to close

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SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- What you are comfortable naming out loud: numbers, timelines, the decision to close
- The three questions you wish someone had asked you at the start, which become the run of show
- Who conducts the fireside and who fields founder questions

3 • LUMA EVENT PAGE

DRAFT COPY, FOR YOUR APPROVAL

B2B: from idea > funding > failure

UPLIFT EXPERT SESSION • MON SEPT 14 • 12:30 PM ET • VIRTUAL • 30 MINUTES

ABOUT THIS SESSION

Founders hear success stories constantly and almost never a first-hand account of the other outcome. Eric Schmalzbauer takes us through the whole arc of his venture-backed B2B startup: the idea, the fundraising, building the team, and the decision to wind it down. He covers what worked, what he would change next time, and what he would do more of. Expect a candid conversation rather than a polished talk.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Tangible examples of what worked and what did not inside a venture-backed startup
- As a founder you always have to be selling, in some form
- Honest acknowledgement that the job is very lonely

ABOUT ERIC

Eric Schmalzbauer is a technology executive, founder, and venture partner across product strategy, data platforms, and go-to-market execution. He is the now former co-Founder and CEO of Prospective, the team behind the open-source Perspective project, building high-performance tools for interactive data analytics. Eric previously held senior leadership roles across financial market infrastructure and enterprise technology, driving product innovation and commercialization. As a Venture Partner at REFASHIOND Ventures, he advises early-stage founders on product-market fit, fundraising, and scaling.

1 • THE SESSION

AT A GLANCE

JULIA KAHKY VP Operations, Tailsight	DATE SESSION 5 MON SEPT 21 • 12:30 PM ET 30 minutes • virtual	FORMAT PRESENTATION, THEN Q&A Aimed at: Every stage, idea through raising
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SESSION TITLE, AS THEY SUBMITTED IT

From startup to dissolution: a post-mortem

OPEN TO OTHER DATES

Yes

BRINGS FOR THE RESOURCE LIBRARY

Her community, The Atrium. The post-mortem deck. A list of AI tools, tips and tricks.

OPEN TO A SERIES, UP TO THREE SESSIONS

Maybe, wants to discuss

DECK

Deck to be sent. Due 72 hours before.

2 • THE ASK

WHAT TO BUILD, AND BY WHEN

- **20 minutes of slides** on the enterprise and regulated sales arc: cycle lengths, where deals died, what she would do differently
- Turn the three takeaways into **actions a founder can take on Monday**
- **10 minutes of questions** at the end

STEP 1 • IMMEDIATELY Calendar hold for this slot goes out as soon as the date is confirmed.	STEP 2 • WEEK PRIOR 15 minute sync call. Lock the title and intro, walk the shape of the 30 minutes, confirm recording and promotion, tech check.	STEP 3 • 72 HOURS OUT Deck due , if a deck is being used, so we can prep and promote.
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SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- How each takeaway becomes something a founder can act on the following Monday
- Which stages to aim at, so the invitation to the cohort has an edge
- Who moderates and how questions reach you, plus where The Atrium and the AI tools list fit

3 • LUMA EVENT PAGE

DRAFT COPY, FOR YOUR APPROVAL

From startup to dissolution: a post-mortem

UPLIFT EXPERT SESSION • MON SEPT 21 • 12:30 PM ET • VIRTUAL • 30 MINUTES

ABOUT THIS SESSION

Everything online is about how companies succeed. Julia Kahky takes the other route and walks through the post-mortem of a startup that closed, specifically what she learned selling software to enterprise customers and into highly regulated markets. Expect specifics on the problems worth avoiding early, product-market fit, and how long sales cycles really take.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Problems to avoid early on
- Product-market fit
- Sales cycles

ABOUT JULIA

Julia Kahky is VP of Operations at a software company in the aviation industry, with prior experience as a chief of staff and in financial technology and operations in sports media. She started her career in finance and has worked across Fortune 15 companies, 500-person companies, and startups, with experience spanning finance, operations, marketing, revenue operations, and HR.